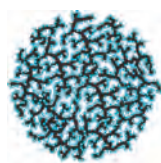


Smartphone market update

MS and Palm plunge in light of the Android threat, even as RIM and Apple hold on tenaciously to their position



Anode power

Anode, a battery design using nanocomposite materials delivers 10 times the capacity of conventional battery designs

Bazaar

Buffalo WHR-HP-G300N

Not quite the beast we expected

The G300N is a nice looking router with a slim body and two rather large, complex looking antennae rising out the top. Overall, the device is compact, build quality is top notch, and the G300N can be stood on a table or wall mounted. It's a Draft N router, and Buffalo provides their AOSS security button that enables WEP encryption — a fancy name for a feature similar to other routers. There is no power button, but a small switch on the rear allows you to select between router and access point modes. Buffalo's interface is pretty good,



though not as intuitive as, say, Linksys' router interface.

In terms of transfer rates, we got a score of 2.81 MBps

in zone 1, and this decreased to 1.23 MBps in zone 2 and 0.68 MBps in zone 3 — pretty mediocre all round and it's noteworthy to see how performance drops alarmingly with attenuation that occurs in zone 3. HD video streaming was possible in zone 1, but not recommended in the other two zones. Similarly in PassMark 3s Performance Test, the initially promising score of 35.4 MBps in zone 1 fell to a measly 10.1 mbps in zone 3. At Rs. 6,000, the G300N is priced at par with its competition, but isn't as good as some of the routers out there in terms of performance.

Specifications

Draft N (802.11n), Speed: 300 mbps max, 4 x RJ45 LAN ports, 1 x WAN port (RJ45)

Contact

Buffalo Inc.

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melcoinc.co.jp

Web site: www.

buffalo-asia.com

Price: Rs. 6,000

5/10

Features.....6
Performance 6.5
Build quality..... 5.5
Value for money..... 3.5

Lian Li A71F

Perfect... almost...

Specifications

Full tower ATX, all aluminium, Fans: 140mm x 2, 120mm x 2, tool-less HDD and expansion card installation

Contact

XTREME GRAFIX

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Email: sudhirsmani@gmail.com

Web site: http://xtremegfx.com/

Price: Rs. 15,650

7/10

Features.....7.5
Performance8
Build quality.....6.5
Value for money.....6

An all aluminium construction and the outer body design is based on simplistic, straight lines. It has an imposing look due to its size, but it's remarkably light. The brushed metal look is not aggressively evident, but it's downright elegant. The front door is pretty thick. The side panels fit flush, but there is room for some movement after using them a bit. The motherboard tray is not removable but a cutout coincides with the CPU region — very convenient for people with CPU coolers that have a backplate. It's deep enough to take the longest graphics cards with at least three inches of room between the end of the card and the HDD bay area. HDDs are installed side-

ways by screwing rubber grommets on to the drive and sliding these into the outward facing bays. The expansion slots are also tool-less and have a very solid all metal design. The power supply can be bottom or top mounted, though it's set up for a bottom-mounted design. On to cooling — two 140 mm fans located on the front suck in air from the venting on the bottom through the HDD trays and inside the system. One complaint is this airflow is not strong enough to penetrate much further than the HDD bays, therefore it doesn't cool anything more



than the HDDs, although it will cause cool air to mill inside the case. There is a rear mounted 120mm fan that sucks out hot air from the CPU region. Cable management is very good. The A71F feels very roomy. At Rs. 15,650, it's good, but not perfect, which, given the price, one would expect it to be.